

Online English Language Resources for ESOL Learners

ADULT EDUCATIONAL GUIDANCE SERVICE, LOETB

Online Resources for English Language Learners to Study at Home

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Introduction

When you are at home, it is important to continue your English language learning. We have put together a list of websites, podcasts, and apps that you can use to improve your English. There are a lot to choose from. You can find the ones that you like. We recommend starting with the British Council website.

The more you are exposed to a language, the faster you will learn. You can read and listen every day and practise your speaking and writing as often as you can.

There are many more websites, podcasts, and apps available to help you. You can request to receive this document in an email which will let you “Ctrl+Click” each link to open the websites. If you have Spotify, you will find the podcasts. The apps can be downloaded for free.

Websites

There are links for beginners to elementary (A0-A2) to make it easier for you. Higher level learners will hopefully be able to navigate the sites to find the correct level of work.

Starting out

[Learn English Online | British Council](#) – This is a brilliant website for all levels. You might like to complete their level test before you start using the resources [Online English level test Learn English \(britishcouncil.org\)](#)

Websites A0-A2 Level (Beginners – Elementary)

[A1 listening | LearnEnglish \(britishcouncil.org\)](#)

[A1 reading | LearnEnglish \(britishcouncil.org\)](#)

[A1 writing | LearnEnglish \(britishcouncil.org\)](#)

[A1 speaking | LearnEnglish \(britishcouncil.org\)](#)

[Grammar Exercises for ESL Learners \(agendaweb.org\)](#)

[Vocabulary Exercises for ESL Learners \(agendaweb.org\)](#)

[Verb Tenses Exercises for ESL Learners \(agendaweb.org\)](#)

[English Grammar Quizzes - Easy \(ESL, EFL\) \(a4esl.org\)](#)

[BBC Learning English - 5 days to become a better listener / Day 1. What's Tim's tip?](#)

[English Reading Quizzes and Games for EFL Students \(esolcourses.com\)](#)

[Learning Chocolate](#) This is a great website for beginners. It looks a little childish but there is a lot of vocabulary with pictures and sound recordings.

[Learn English - LanguageGuide.org](#) An online picture dictionary. It is very good, but the English is American English.

[Voice of America - Learn American English with VOA Learning English \(voanews.com\)](#)

Websites For All Levels

These websites have work for all levels of English language learning. You will need to search for your level. If you find it difficult to choose the correct section, we suggest starting with the links for A0-A1 above.

[Learn English Online | British Council](#) – This is a brilliant website for all levels. It also has a site specifically for teenagers: [A1 reading | LearnEnglish Teens \(britishcouncil.org\)](#)



BBC Learning English

The BBC's Learning English websites have lots and lots of resources. Take your time looking through these.

[BBC Learning English - Take an English course with BBC Learning English Learning English - BBC.co.uk:](#)

[BreakingNewsEnglish.com](#)

Breaking News English is a **free site with ready-to-use ESL lessons**, handouts, graded news articles at A2/B1 to B1/B2 levels including listening activities, online quizzes, podcasts, and communicative activities. Each text is available at various levels, and you can read and listen or just read. Vocabulary questions to support learning

[English File | Learning Resources | Oxford University Press \(oup.com\)](#)

Learn more English here with interactive exercises, useful downloads, games, and weblinks. Practise your grammar, practical English, vocabulary, pronunciation, listening, and reading, and have some fun too. Third Edition at levels from A1 to C1.

[Headway Student's Site | Learning Resources | Oxford University Press \(oup.com\)](#)

Select your level to browse interactive exercises and downloadable audio and video resources. 4th Edition - Grammar, vocabulary, everyday English, reading, listening and tests

[Alison.com](#)

Hundreds of short online English language courses covering many different areas including vocabulary and English for specific job areas. You can complete all of the courses for free but if you want to get the certificate of completion you will need to pay for it. Please note; the English taught may be American English

Beginner Courses

[Beginner Level English - Food | Free Online Course | Alison](#)
[Beginner Level English \(Online\) Course | Foundations | Alison](#)
[Free Course - English Vocabulary and Pronunciation | Alison](#)
[Fundamentals of English Grammar | Free Online Course | Alison](#)
[Basic English Grammar Diploma Course | 2017 | Alison](#)

Science vocabulary

[English for STEM Online Course Free | Alison](#)

English for Hospitality Staff

[English for Restaurant Staff Free Online Course | Alison](#)
[English for Tourism: Tourist Information, Guided Tours Course | Alison](#)
[English for Hotel Reception and Front Desk Online Course | Alison](#)
[English Language for Healthcare | Free Online Course | Alison](#)



Business English

[Introduction to Business English | Free Online Course | Alison](#)
[English for Business Communication | Free Online Course | Alison](#)
[English for Business and Tourism | Free Online Course | Alison](#)
[Economics and Perfect Infinitives | Free Online Course | Alison](#)

Other English Language Learning sites

- [Test your English - Every level and every skill \(test-english.com\)](#)
- [English Exercises - Learn English with ESL Activities \(agendaweb.org\)](#)
- [Sentence grammar: Punctuation - BBC Teach](#)
- [ESOL Punctuation - Teaching resources \(wordwall.net\)](#)
- [EWE – Easy World Of English](#)
- [Activities for ESL/EFL Students \(English Study\) \(a4esl.org\)](#)
- [English Reading Quizzes and Games for EFL Students \(esolcourses.com\)](#)
- [Learning English | Cambridge English | Learning English | Cambridge English](#)
- [EF.com- Resources for learning English](#)
- [Using English.com](#)
- [EnglishPage.com](#)
- [Wyzant ESL Lessons and Help](#)
- [ESL-lab Listening Skills comprehension](#)
- [OxfordOnlineEnglish.com - Free-English-Lessons](#)

Laois & Offaly Libraries

The Library service is fantastic resource. To use the library resources, you will need to join the library. Then you can visit the library in any town in the county. There are a lot of free, online courses available through the library.

Laois

- [Laois Library Service](#)
- [Join the Laois Library online](#)

Offaly

- [Offaly Library Service](#)
- [Join the Offaly Library online](#)

Members of any Irish library can take part in free, online classes through [Universal Class:](#)

Apps

There are many language learning apps. You can download and start using most of them for

free. Most of them have more advanced features that you will need to pay for, however. We have tested several apps, and these are the best free ones we have found.

- [Duolingo](#): A very well-known app with many languages to choose from.
- [Memrise](#) Another good app with many languages to choose from. You will need to pay to use the more advanced features.
- [Learn English Grammar British Council](#): This is another British Council app. You can use it for free with ads or pay a fee to use it without ads. There are practise grammar exercises at all levels and tests to check your learning.

Podcasts

There are many podcasts available to learn English. You will find a list below. You can find more simply by searching 'learning English' or 'beginner English,' for A2 - B2 levels

[The BBC offers the following list of podcasts](#):

- 6-minute English – B1/ B2 learners
- Learning English Vocabulary – A2 + learners
- BBC Learning English -
- Learning English for work
- Learning English Grammar
- Learning English Conversations
- Learning English from the News
- Learning Easy English
- Learning English Stories

[Learn English Podcast](#): This is a British Council podcast. In the app, you can read the transcript and complete exercises.

[Business English Podcast](#) – Covers English Language for Business situations. Please note it is mainly American English that is used.

[Podcasts in English.com](#) Huge variety of English language learning podcasts on various topics. The Podcasts are free but paid members receive worksheets and transcripts.

YouTube

YouTube is a fantastic resource for learning a language or any new skills. Below we have suggested some channels for learning English, but you will find many, many more. For each channel, we have provided a link to one video, as an example.

Beginner English [Food in English - Beginner English \(youtube.com\)](#)

English Course Beginner 1 [Beginner English 1 - Introduction](#)

Easy English Practice [Everyday English Conversation Practice | Listening](#)

Esther's English Lessons <https://youtu.be/94qlL8CSOrk?feature=shared>

For Arabic speakers: Apna Teacher <https://youtu.be/fKlK0-0Pca4?feature=shared>

Learn English in 30 minutes <https://youtu.be/juKd26qkNAw?feature=shared>

Phrases for B1/ Intermediate learners <https://youtu.be/XzjQV5oRtOQ?feature=shared>



B1 + Oxford Online English <https://youtu.be/jul2urONzOQ?feature=shared>

News words <https://youtu.be/W3TIs0ipDXY?feature=shared>

Learning English with songs:

Listening to songs is a very beneficial way to improve your English. On YouTube you can listen to the song AND read the lyrics. There are millions of videos to choose from, just find the songs that you like. Here are some examples:

<https://youtu.be/TyzlG-lrLhg?feature=shared> (Irish songs)

<https://youtu.be/sJQYoGyEtDs?feature=shared> (pop selection)

https://youtu.be/-YUAbW_YDm4?feature=shared (songs from the 1980s)

TV and film are also fantastic resources for language learning. On YouTube you will find clips from TV and film with subtitles.

Learn English with TV series <https://youtu.be/t0ruAx3WwjQ?feature=shared> (this is for B1/B1+)

Ted Talks

Ted Talks might be more suitable for those of you who have good English already. Ted Talks provide transcripts so you can read and listen at the same time. You can find Ted Talks on any topic you are interested in. We have included a small selection for you to begin exploring Ted Talks in English.

3 best Ted Talks for Learning English <https://youtu.be/zNxdtSIQo9g?feature=shared>

The secrets of learning a new language https://youtu.be/o_XVt5rdpFY?feature=shared

The Irish language and beauty <https://youtu.be/mRlaLSdRMMs?feature=shared>

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